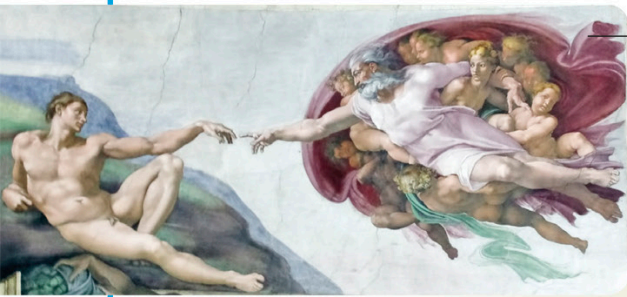




Vatican City



This part of the ceiling shows God creating Adam, the first man.

0 150 metres
0 150 yards
(approximate scale)

Vatican Gardens

More than half of Vatican City is made up of gardens with many statues, fountains, and grottoes.



Sistine Chapel

The Sistine Chapel was built in the Vatican Palace during the 15th century. The ceiling features vast wall paintings by the Italian artist Michelangelo.



Swiss Guard

Since the 16th century, armed guards in traditional uniform have protected the pope and Vatican City.

Halberds are ceremonial weapons carried by the Swiss Guards.



Pope Francis

Born in Argentina in 1936, Pope Francis is the current head of the Catholic Church.



Coins from the Vatican

The country adopted the euro as currency in 2000 but produces its own euro coins, some of which show the Pope.



St. Peter's Square

Up to 300,000 people are able to gather in St. Peter's Square to listen to the pope speak. It takes its name from Saint Peter, who Catholics consider the first pope.



St. Peter's Basilica is the largest church in the world.



- ☑ 0.17 sq miles (0.44 sq km)
- 👤 1,000
- ★ None
- 🇮🇹 Italian, Latin

Located within the Italian capital of Rome is Vatican City, the **smallest country** on Earth. This tiny city-state is **home** to the **Pope**, the **head** of the **Roman Catholic Church**.

